

Wednesday, 29th June, 2016

Current Safety and Security issues in Gorkha

A quick meeting was held on 29 June, 2016, between key partners regarding current safety and Security situations. Some I/NGOs got calls from certain political groups and requested to halt field Operations due to various issues and partners are highly concerned regarding these issues.

The meeting was facilitated by HRRP Gorkha and Lead by Gorkha DLSA and attended by representatives of various organizations, namely DFID, CARE, World Vision, Caritas, CRS, OXFAM, and International Organization for Migration (IOM), PIN and others.

Partners were updated by Gorkha DLSA with suggestion made by AIN Steering Committee and the BOGs secretariat to deal with the request from such groups or political parties. Many Members present did not know the directions and guidelines provided by AIN at Kathmandu Level. After Discussion, action points were agreed and suggested by partners to avoid future risk and to prepare themselves to cope with the situation at District level:

- To maintain low profile (less visibility) for certain time period as long as required.
- The suggestions made by AIN is reemphasized as highlighted later in this document.
- Provide Regular update do District level Government regarding their needs and programs to maintain transparency.
- Ministry of Home Affairs have directed district authority to collect information about international staff in organizations for safety issues. It was not clear if this is requested from all INGOs/NGOs at district level but so far, there is no international staffs in Gorkha except CRS and IOM and only CRS has been requested to provide the information related to international staffs. It was also discussed and advised that information can be provided to the local police, since they asked for this and mentioned that it is a routine job by them.
- Proposal for group meetings (POs) with responsible leaders from respective political parties if necessary in future.
- Depending upon the situation, Continuity of this group for more discussions and suggestions for advocacy and preparation led by relevant district lead coordination bodies.
- In case, If there will demand about the financial details and upcoming programs, politely convey the message that they can get It from DDC as the organization have submitted those documents before they took approval from the government.
- Consultation and participation of UNDSS or relevant UN agencies existing in district.

Suggestions for all AIN members from central level as output of discussion held at central level to deal with the situations are copied below.

For the attention of AIN Members: Forwarding the message below from Damian Turk/ BOGs Officer. Kindly share it with your staff members. Thank you, Lucky

Dear AIN members,

As we all know the operational space context is rapidly changing with the activities of the CPN M (Biplab). As some of you have experienced his representatives at the district level are visiting or calling district based offices of INGOs, particularly in the EQ districts requesting organization to halt operations until further notice from the party.

In this regard I would like to make the following suggestions to all organizations regarding how to deal with these requests -

- If your organization is approached and a meeting requested, please meet them. However, ensure you meet them during office hours and in your own offices with more than one person present and with a Security Officer if you have them.
- During the meeting try to establish the identity and contact details of the person representing the CPN M (Biplab), introduce yourselves, avoid providing personal mobile numbers if possible - provide office number
- If possible, keep a record of the meeting, what was said and by whom
- listen to what they have to say, give them time to speak and acknowledge their concerns
- Explain that their concerns will be forwarded to office HQ in KTM - not possible to make decision at the district level (where applicable)
- Please immediately inform the AIN Steering Committee and the BOGs secretariat of any incidents providing as much detailed information as possible.